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Doubao liked to cling to older sisters.

Whether it was Chaochao and Mumu, or Ling Dang and Sheng Yu, any of them would do.

She mainly liked to throw herself into groups of beautiful women. Previously, when Shen Hui took her to the hospital, just in the time it took to walk from the first floor to the second floor, Doubao had used her lisping speech to charm three beautiful women, and had even kissed all of them on the face.

Shen Hui posted about this in the family group chat, along with several speechless emoji stickers.

The result was Zhu Mingqi saying: 【Takes after you.】

Shen Hui: 【?】

Shen Hui immediately defended herself, but even Shen Fenghe chimed in: 【Otherwise, how did you set your sights on Zhao Xuning?】

Shen Hui: 【.....】

Well, that wasn't wrong.

Back then, she had indeed been deceived by Zhao Xuning's good looks.

So Doubao's this trait was inherited from Shen Hui.

But Shen Hui would never admit this in front of Zhao Xuning.

So when Doubao kissed Chaochao's face full of drool in the room, Chaochao came out holding Doubao with a dejected face, calling out pitifully: "Auntie."

Shen Hui took one look and immediately covered her eyes.

She couldn't bear to look.

Doubao was still grinning foolishly at Shen Hui, as if proudly saying—Look, I kissed the pretty jiejie.

Shen Hui found some tissues to wipe Chaochao's face, and gave Doubao's hand a pat while she was at it.

But Doubao thought Shen Hui was playing a hand-clapping game with her and reached out her hand with a smile.

Shen Hui looked at that face that so resembled Zhao Xuning and felt helpless.

But soon, Chaochao took Doubao to play again, and Shen Hui went to the study to check on the situation with Xu Qingzhu.

The moment she opened the door, she saw Mumu with a red nose from crying. The moment she saw Shen Hui come in, she immediately looked over with an aggrieved expression, her big eyes blinking, as if seeking help.

Xu Qingzhu called out coldly: "Shen Xuan."

It wasn't very stern, just completely devoid of emotion. Mumu immediately stood at attention like a soldier.

Shen Hui stood to the side without saying anything.

Xu Qingzhu stood there with her arms crossed, while Mumu stood against the wall, head lowered, not daring to speak.

She wasn't crying as loudly as before either.

"When you truly know you were wrong, that's when you can talk to me again." Xu Qingzhu said.

After saying this, Xu Qingzhu was about to walk out. Mumu immediately ran over and hugged her leg, crying "wuwuwu."

It was different from the loud wailing before.

The loud wailing was because she had hoped someone would come save her. Now that she knew it was useless, and was afraid Xu Qingzhu would really leave and ignore her, she hugged Xu Qingzhu and cried as if heartbroken.

"I know I was wrong, Mommy." Mumu apologized with a choked voice: "I'll apologize to him tomorrow... wuwuwu....."

Shen Hui glanced at Xu Qingzhu, and their eyes happened to meet.

Xu Qingzhu gave her a look, and Shen Hui understood instantly, immediately speaking up: "What did Shen Xuan do wrong?"

"On her first day of kindergarten, she stuck out her foot and tripped a classmate." Xu Qingzhu said.

Shen Hui clicked her tongue: "So she's the little tyrant of kindergarten."

"Yes, spoiled at home until she thinks she can do anything." Xu Qingzhu glanced at Mumu. Mumu was also secretly looking at her, but the moment their eyes met, she immediately lowered her head.

Xu Qingzhu scoffed lightly, "Who knows how much trouble she wants to cause."

"That child's mother probably can't even eat dinner tonight." Shen Hui sighed lightly, "If someone tripped my Doubao, I'd go beat up whoever did it."

Hearing this, Mumu immediately shrank back, looking at Shen Hui fearfully.

Terrified that Shen Hui would hit her.

Xu Qingzhu shrugged: "Anyway, the one who got tripped wasn't Shen Xuan, so she wouldn't feel the pain."

Shen Hui nodded: "That's right."

"Mommy, Auntie, I'm sorry." Shen Xuan apologized.

"Are we the ones you should be saying sorry to?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Shen Xuan blinked.

Xu Qingzhu squatted down to look at her at eye level: "What I want to tell you today is that no matter how capable or powerful you are, you cannot bully others. If one day you become very powerful, becoming an Alpha who can fight and has strength, then I hope you'll protect others, not hurt them."

"That little boy was crying just because he missed his mom. You and your sister are in the same class—you have a companion, but he doesn't." Xu Qingzhu earnestly educated her: "His mom also said he's had poor health since he was little. As someone who is healthy and has a companion, do you think it's appropriate for you to bully him?"

This time, Shen Xuan answered without hesitation: "It's not appropriate."

Xu Qingzhu asked her: "Even if he were a normal child, you still can't trip him. Never bully or hurt others, understand?"

Shen Xuan nodded.

Finally done educating Shen Xuan, they put this matter behind them.

Only then did Xu Qingzhu contact the other child's parent, explaining the situation to them on WeChat, and expressing hope that her son could continue being Shen Xuan's desk mate. She needed to correct this bad habit of Shen Xuan's.

The other parent was actually reluctant. After all, he was also her precious darling. If Shen Xuan did something unreasonable again, she couldn't exactly hold it against a little child.

As a fellow parent, Xu Qingzhu could understand her concerns, so she said she could give Shen Xuan a probation period. If she didn't pass, they could have the teacher change the seating arrangement, or they could even transfer classes or schools.

She just wanted to correct Shen Xuan's temper.

At home, Liang Shi had always spoiled her, and because she had a sweet mouth and knew how to coax people, whenever Xu Qingzhu wanted to discipline her, she would run over and act cute before Xu Qingzhu had the chance. And since they were never matters of principle, Xu Qingzhu would let them pass lightly every time.

But encountering something like this, there was absolutely no way she could just let it pass.

This was probably the first time Xu Qingzhu had gotten angry since they turned three.

Because of Xu Qingzhu's assurance, the other parent said she would ask her child for his opinion and think about it.

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After finishing the conversation with the other parent, Xu Qingzhu put down her phone and chatted with Shen Hui, asking where Shen Fenghe and the others were.

Today wasn't any special day. If she had to name something, it should be the day Gu Yixue returned to the country.

Gu Yixue, who had been filming a new movie abroad, was returning to China today. Everyone had mentioned it when they were about to get off work, and so they all gathered at Liang Shi's home to eat.

It was just the younger generation.

Because Zhu Mingqi and Father Shen had gone on an expedition to the Arctic.

They had already been gone for a week, and the photos they sent were indeed spectacular.

The suggestion to explore the Arctic had actually come from Sheng Linlang.

At the time, they were having a family dinner when Zhu Mingqi brought up wanting to go out and have fun. She said that for most of her life, she had never traveled with her husband—it was more often business trips. She had been to all those Western European countries, just never had a chance to properly enjoy them.

If she went back now, she would only be reminded of the sad memories of those cities, so she didn't want to go.

But she still really wanted to travel.

So Sheng Linlang recommended the North and South Poles.

Both the Antarctic and Arctic had their own unique charm, and both were worth visiting.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised at the time, not knowing when Sheng Linlang and the others had gone to the poles.

Sheng Linlang smiled shyly, "I was too cooped up in those earlier years. It wasn't until after you joined the company that your dad and I had time to go out and enjoy ourselves."

It was only later, when Xu Qingzhu asked privately, that she learned Sheng Linlang had actually suffered from severe depression during that time.

She had been taking antidepressant medication all along.

Years of accumulated worries, rarely leaving the house on normal days—it had almost crushed Sheng Linlang entirely.

Fortunately, Xu Guangyao had stepped down from his position at that time and stayed by her side, and she slowly recovered.

Xu Qingzhu felt extremely guilty after hearing this, but Sheng Linlang told her not to take it to heart.

As for Zhu Mingqi, she took Sheng Linlang's advice and almost immediately started planning, taking Father Shen to both the North and South Poles.

Now there were only the younger generation at home.

Everyone was chatting about what genre Gu Yixue had been filming abroad when the doorbell rang.

Xu Qingzhu was just about to stand up to get the door when she noticed Mumu had already run all the way to the entrance.

She wasn't tall enough to reach the door handle, but she had moved a stool from nearby.

Normally, Xu Qingzhu kept a stool by the door to make it easier for them to change shoes, which now conveniently helped Mumu.

Mumu was an expert at being well-behaved in front of relatives.

The moment Gu Yixue saw her, she immediately picked her up. Being very observant, she noticed her red nose and eyes and asked: "Who bullied you? Why were you crying? Auntie will go get revenge for you."

Mumu shook her head: "I was the one who bullied someone else."

"Then why are you crying?" Gu Yixue was surprised.

Mumu buried her head in her neck, her voice muffled yet still milky: "I'm ashamed."

Everyone: "?"

Everyone burst out laughing at the same time.

Shen Fenghe, who had always been a woman of few words, had bought some fruit when she came and carried it all the way to the living room.

Although she had picked up Gu Yixue, she had no interaction with Gu Yixue the entire time.

Shen Hui even secretly asked her: "Did you have a fight with sister-in-law?"

Shen Fenghe was expressionless: "No."

On the other side, Liang Shi also asked Gu Yixue: "Did you have a fight with my sister?"

Gu Yixue tossed an apple into the air: "Do you think I'm worthy?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi looked at her with slight disdain: "Director Gu, when are you going to get your act together?"¹

Gu Yixue sneaked closer: "What? Want to see your sister get put in her place?"

Liang Shi: ".....I just think you're being too humble. I'm not telling you to bully my sister either."

Gu Yixue took a bite of the apple and laughed lightly: "I don't know what's wrong with her either."

There was some indifference in that laugh, tinged with confusion.

Liang Shi didn't know what to say either, and could only pat her shoulder comfortingly.

Gu Yixue took another bite of the apple, and a few seconds later, with lowered eyes, she said: "We might be getting divorced."

Liang Shi was cutting vegetables. Hearing this, she was so startled that her hand slipped, and the kitchen knife cut right into her hand.

Blood immediately flowed out.

She didn't even care about the pain and turned her head to ask: "What did you say?"

Gu Yixue glanced at her hand but didn't answer. Instead, she called out toward the outside: "Xu Qingzhu, your wife cut her hand."

Soon, the kitchen was crowded with people.

But Liang Shi was distracted.

She didn't care about her hand at all. Instead, she looked at Gu Yixue standing outside the crowd. She was leaning lazily against the wall, her whole demeanor showing dejection, holding a fresh apple in her hand, biting it carelessly.

The feeling she gave off was more like she was smoking a cigarette.

There was a ready-made doctor in the house. Although using her to bandage a knife wound was overkill, having her handle this kind of wound wouldn't make it feel painful.

Though it might also have been that Liang Shi was numb.

She really wanted to ask Gu Yixue what she meant, but she saw Gu Yixue, through the crowd of people, raise a finger to her own lips: "Shh."

Liang Shi lowered her eyes.

Since Liang Shi could no longer cook now, the kitchen became Zhao Xuning's domain.

After Gu Yixue finished her apple, she also came to help.

They didn't cook much—most of it was delivery that Shen Fenghe had ordered.

Before long, Shen Siyan arrived belatedly.

Shen Siyan had also joined the company now. Although he was a fresh graduate, he handled things decisively and efficiently.

Shen Fenghe was currently mentoring him. In Shen Fenghe's words, his edges were too sharp, but correspondingly, he had the vigor of youth.

Given time, he would definitely achieve great things.

The whole family ate together happily.

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1. "支棱起来" (zhī léng qǐ lái) is internet slang meaning to pull oneself together, get one's act together, or become more assertive/confident. Here, Liang Shi is asking when Gu Yixue will stop being so humble and passive in her relationship. ⇐